



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

devaiḥ śvamāṃsaṃ bhoktavyam āpannam ṛṣikalpitam || 13 || BRP093.013.1

agnes tadvacanād indraḥ śyeno bhūtvā vihāyasi | BRP093.014.1

sthālīm athāharat pūrṇāṃ māṃsena pihitām tadā || 14 || BRP093.014.2

tat karma dṛṣṭvā śiṣyās te ṛṣeḥ śyenaṃ nyavedayan | BRP093.015.1

hṛtā sthālī munisreṣṭha śyenenākṛtabuddhinā || 15 || BRP093.015.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 93: Story of Viśvāmitra and Indra (Chapter 93), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Brahmapurāṇa, detailing a bizarre episode involving Viśvāmitra, Indra, and dog meat, offers a potent lesson in navigating dharma during times of extreme adversity. Viśvāmitra, undergoing a severe famine, finds himself in dire straits. The verse speaks of deities being compelled to eat dog meat, a ritually impure act, but sanctioned by the ṛṣis in the face of starvation. This highlights the principle of *āpad-dharma*, the dharma applicable during emergencies where normal rules are suspended to preserve life.

Indra, acting on Agni's word, transforms into a hawk and steals a pot of meat. This action, seemingly dishonorable, is driven by the need to test Viśvāmitra's resolve and potentially alleviate the famine. The disciples witnessing this theft report it to Viśvāmitra, lamenting the deed of the "unintelligent hawk."

The spiritual significance lies in understanding that dharma is not a rigid set of rules but a flexible framework guided by compassion and wisdom. Viśvāmitra, a powerful sage, faces a moral dilemma. Should he adhere strictly to dietary laws, even at the cost of his life and the lives of his disciples? Or should he embrace the exception, recognizing the higher dharma of survival? Indra's act, though unconventional, forces Viśvāmitra to confront this question.

In modern life, we often encounter situations where rigid adherence to rules clashes with ethical considerations. Perhaps you face a situation at work where bending the rules slightly can help a colleague in need, or you're torn between following a legal requirement and doing what feels morally right. This story encourages you to cultivate discernment, to weigh the consequences of your actions, and to prioritize compassion and the preservation of life, both physical and spiritual, above blind adherence to dogma. The key is to act with awareness, understanding the context and potential impact of your choices, striving to align your actions with the highest good possible in that specific moment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

When have you faced a situation where you had to choose between following a rule and doing what felt right, and what did you learn from that experience about the true meaning of dharma?